

Samsung Galaxy S23

The perfect compact Android smartphone?

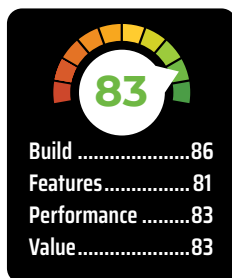
Compact phone lovers can rejoice with the launch of the new Samsung Galaxy S23, packed with a new SoC, larger battery, and a revamped design. But, is the Samsung Galaxy S23 worth its hefty price tag though? Or does it lose ground to the Pixel 7 and the iPhone 14? Let's find out

BUILD AND DESIGN

The first difference you will notice about the Samsung Galaxy S23 when compared to its predecessor is the lack of contour-cut camera housing. The smartphone is still lightweight. It is also thinner than Apple's iPhone 14. This, combined with the rounded-off edges, gives the phone a very pleasant and ergonomic in-hand feel. The back glass has a matte finish that does quite well at rejecting fingerprints and smudges. Samsung has advertised that their new "Armor Aluminium Frame" comes with tougher drop and scratch resistance. The display is protected by Corning Gorilla Glass Victus 2, with improved drop resistance. The phone is also IP68 dust and water-resistant too.

DISPLAY

Moving on to the display, we measured around 580 nits of brightness on High Brightness Mode and 1,290 on Auto Brightness. We didn't record the rated peak brightness levels in our tests, that is usually attainable in controlled environments. The display is still plenty bright for outdoors usage. The display is also HDR10+ compliant. It is fantastic with rich, vibrant colours, deep blacks, and really good viewing angles. With a PPI count of 425, everything looks super crisp and detailed. The display also has 120 Hz Adaptive Refresh Rate and refreshes in steps.



PERFORMANCE

Compared to the iPhone 14 and the Pixel 7 – its main two competitors – the phone was comfortably ahead in numbers in AnTuTu. Geekbench saw the iPhone 14 take the lead back, but the S23 still came out in front of the Pixel

7. In PCMarkWork, the S23 came out on top. Coming to GPU tests, the Galaxy S23 clocked in fantastic scores in 3D Mark and GFXBench. However, the phone does get warm to the touch when playing intensive games and running intensive benchmarks. We also ran the CPU Throttling Test and after 15 minutes of the test, the phone throttled to 68 per cent of its peak performance. Benchmarks aside, even in day-to-day usage, the phone feels fast and responsive.

CAMERA

The Samsung Galaxy S23's main camera provides excellent shots in daylight with good detail, sharpness, great dynamic range, exposure, and vivid colours. In tricky lighting conditions, you can see some noise creep in the shadows when you pixel peep. Full 50 MP shooting mode provides

higher levels of detail and accurate colours. But, the shots are slightly noisier than the binned images. The 3x telephoto lens click rich-looking photos. The telephoto lens takes some fantastic low-light shots with Night Mode active with minimal noise. The ultrawide lens is impressive, as usual. Portrait shots from the main camera are excellent. The 3x portraits are also surprisingly good. The selfie camera, with its new HDR abilities, offers great dynamic range. Low light shots on the main camera offer great levels of detail, and good colours. Video from the primary and telephoto lenses have great stability due to OIS.

BATTERY LIFE

The Galaxy S23 provides excellent battery life. We got over 17 hours of runtime in our 4K video loop test, which is excellent performance. As for charging, the phone tops up from zero to full in about 65 minutes, but this still feels laboriously slow on a pricey phone in 2023.

VERDICT

As the current smartphone landscape goes, the Samsung Galaxy S23 is the best compact Android phone we've ever tested. Despite its compact form factor, the phone manages to win you over. It is a well-rounded phone in every sense of the word that offers flagship-grade performance without the premium price tag. While some may still prefer the iPhone 14, this phone will give them a real reason to make the switch. However, we'd urge everyone to go for the 256 GB variant of the phone over the base variant to leverage faster memory speeds across the board.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Chipset: Qualcomm Snapdragon 8 Gen 2 for Galaxy | GPU: Adreno 740 | OS: Android 13, One UI 5.1 | Display: 6.1-inches Dynamic AMOLED 2x, 1080 x 2340 pixels | Refresh rate: Adaptive 120 Hz | RAM: 8 GB LPDDR5 | ROM: 128 GB UFS 3.1 | Cameras (rear): 50 MP + 10 MP (telephoto) + 12 MP (ultrawide) | Selfie camera: 12 MP | Video: Up to 8K @30 fps | Battery capacity: 3,900 mAh | Charging wattage: 25 W (wired), 15 W (wireless)

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